# Year 7 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

**Version 3.1, October 2026.** Use with `Y07/Y07_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Version 3.1 is version 2 with the third reading text (Part C) removed: the listening, writing, maths, science and interview are unchanged from version 2. The reading paper is now Parts A and B (16 marks) in the same time as before. Do not mix papers and instructions from different versions: the question numbers, marks and band guides differ.

**Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages.** Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y07_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For students applying to join **Year 7** (age 11 to 12 on 1 September). A Year 7 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 5** and is the same age as a student starting Grade 6. The maths paper starts at the level expected for entry to Year 7 (the end of UK Year 6) and goes well beyond it, so several topics (dividing fractions, powers, negative numbers, percentages, expanding brackets, equations with the unknown on both sides, the nth term, vertically opposite angles) **may not have been taught yet**. Section 4 lists them. Background, the English bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

## 1. At a glance

| Order | Task | Minutes | Who leads | Materials | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Welcome | 2 | Assessor | Student paper, pencil, rubber, ruler | Script in Section 2 |
| 2 | Listening (paper pages 2 to 5): Part A, a phone message; Part B, a short talk | about 15 (recording) | Assessor plays the recording, or reads each script twice | These instructions, Section 3.1; the recording | Can be done with a small group |
| 3 | Reading paper (pages 6 to 9) | 15 | Student works alone; assessor times | Clock or timer | Do not read the texts aloud |
| 4 | Writing (pages 10 to 11) | 10 | Student works alone | | Choose one of two tasks |
| 5 | Break | 5 | | Water | |
| 6 | Maths (pages 12 to 17) | 25 | Student; assessor may read questions aloud | No calculator, no protractor | Section A fluency, Section B word questions, Section C applied problems |
| 7 | Science (pages 18 to 20) | 8 | Student; assessor may read questions aloud | | |
| 8 | Interview, opening with sentence reading | 15 | Interviewer, 1:1 | Interviewer guide, Interview sheet, Reading front sheet, Sentence reading guide and card, a plain card | Sentence reading starts at **Level 6** (sentence 16) |
| | **Total** | **about 95** | | | Plus the parent conversation (about 15 minutes, separate) |

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths and science), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

**For each candidate:**

- the Year 7 v3.1 student paper (20 pages, A4);
- the grading sheet (`Y07/Y07_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 7 to 10 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

**For the room (print once, laminate the cards):**

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a pencil, a rubber and a ruler for each candidate, a clock or timer, a plain card to cover the sentences, and water for the break.

## 2. Before you start

**Welcome script.** Say, in a calm, friendly voice:

> "Hello, I'm … . Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities in English: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and find the right support for you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best, and it is OK if you cannot answer everything. In maths and science I can read a question to you. In the English parts I cannot explain words, because we want to see your English. You can always ask me to say an instruction again. Do you have any questions?"

**Pace of speech.** Many Year 7 students are still learning English: speak steadily, slightly slower than normal speech, about 160 words a minute, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

**Access rules** (the same in every year group; details in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 7)

| | **English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)** | **Maths and science** |
|---|---|---|
| Reading aloud | Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate or read the reading texts aloud. You may repeat instructions in English. | Read any question aloud in English, as often as asked, and point to the picture. |
| Chinese | Not used by staff. | If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Mark the question **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. |
| Answers | **In English only.** An answer in Chinese scores 0. | **In English only.** Numbers, ticks, drawings and working count. An answer, reason or explanation written in Chinese scores 0, even after an L reading. |
| Not yet taught | | If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics and L questions on the grading sheet. |

- **Extra time or a reader** for a known need is allowed; record it on the grading sheet.
- **Stopping.** The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Listening Part B is meant to stretch fluent students: a student who is new to English may follow little of it, and that is expected. In the reading paper, if the student is clearly stuck, let them stop and say "Thank you, that is fine." In maths, the paper goes well

beyond the expected level, so many students will not finish; reassure them. In writing, if the student cannot write in English, ask them to write any words they know, or a plan; do not score Chinese writing, but keep it. Never push a distressed student: take a break or stop, and record it on the grading sheet.

- **Keeping the student at ease.** Explain the order of the morning and the break. Sit beside, not opposite, for the interview. Praise effort, not answers ("Thank you, you are working hard"). Do not show surprise at mistakes. Keep the timer out of the student's line of sight, and give a calm two-minute warning near the end of each timed part.

## 3. English

### 3.1 Listening (about 15 minutes with the recording, 16 marks)

Two parts, each read twice. **Part A** is everyday listening: the version 1 task, unchanged (questions 1 to 8). **Part B** is academic listening: a short lesson at the level of a science lesson for a fluent student of 11 or 12 (questions 9 to 16). Read Part A, let the student finish, then go straight on to Part B. The recording takes about 15 minutes: both scripts twice, one minute to read each set of questions and the time to finish.

**Recording.** A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y07/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of Part A takes about 1 minute 58 seconds and of Part B about 2 minutes 39 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

#### Part A: a phone message (questions 1 to 8, 8 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Listening page. This is Part A. I am going to read a phone message. Li Na is calling her friend Sofia. I will read it two times. First, read the questions." Give the student **one minute** to look at questions 1 to 8 (pages 2 and 3). Then say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

**Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2** (about 160 words a minute). Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish. Do not repeat any part of the message, and do not explain any word.

> **Script: a phone message**
>
> Hi Sofia, it's Li Na. I'm calling about our plan for Saturday. **[pause]**
>
> The cinema in Riverside Mall is closed this weekend, so we can't see the film. Let's go to the science museum instead. **[pause]**
>
> We can meet outside the main entrance at half past nine. **[pause]**
>
> The easiest way to get there is by metro. My dad is picking us up at four o'clock, so you don't need to take the metro home. **[pause]**
>
> Please bring your student card, because students get cheaper tickets. And bring a packed lunch. The café in the museum is really expensive, and we can eat in the garden. **[pause]**
>
> On the metro, take Line 2 and get off at Lakeside Station. Then use Exit 4. The museum is right in front of you. **[pause]**
>
> Tickets are usually 40 yuan, but students only pay 25 yuan. **[pause]**
>
> Please don't be late, because the first show in the space theatre starts at ten o'clock. **[pause]**
>
> My brother Jun went to the museum last week. He's fourteen, and he thinks everything is boring. But even he said the robot exhibition was amazing! It closes on Sunday, so this is our last chance to see it. **[pause]**
>
> Please send me a message tonight and tell me if you can come. Bye!

**Answers.** One mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

| Q | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept, and what it tells you |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **B** science museum | | A (cinema): heard "cinema" but missed "closed". C: heard "Mall". |
| 2 | **B** 9:30 | | C (10:00): heard the time of the show, not the meeting time. |
| 3 | **B** metro | | C (car): heard "My dad is picking us up", which is for going home. |
| 4 | **Both** student card **and** packed lunch | | One correct only, or three or more ticked: 0. "Money for the café" is a distractor. |
| 5 | **4** | four | 2 (the metro line). |
| 6 | **25** | 25 yuan, ¥25 | 40 (the usual price): missed "but students only pay". |
| 7 | The first show (in the space theatre) starts at ten. | They will miss the show; the show is at 10; they must be there before the show. | "Because they meet at half past nine" with no reason. |
| 8 | To show that the robot exhibition must be very good: even her brother, who thinks everything is boring, liked it. | To make Sofia want to come; because the robots are amazing; because it is good and it closes soon. | "Because he is fourteen"; "because he is boring". |

### Part B: a short talk (questions 9 to 16, 8 marks)

**Say:** "Now turn to Part B, on page 4. You will hear a short talk. A science teacher is giving a lesson about deserts. I will read it two times. You have one minute to read questions 9 to 16." After **one minute**, say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

**Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2** (about 160 words a minute), as you would explain something to a class of fluent 11 year olds. Pause for 2 to 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give **one minute** to finish. Do not slow down to dictation speed, speed up, repeat any part, or explain any word: Part B measures whether the student can follow a lesson in English at this pace.

**Script: a short lesson about deserts**

Good morning, everyone. Today we are finding out how plants and animals survive in one of the harshest habitats on Earth: the desert. **[pause]**

When you hear the word "desert", you probably imagine golden sand and blazing sunshine. However, scientists define a desert by its precipitation, which means rain or snow, rather than by its temperature. A desert receives less than 250 millimetres of precipitation a year, while Shanghai, by comparison, gets more than a thousand. By this definition, about a third of the land on our planet is desert. The largest is the Sahara, in North Africa. Actually, I need to correct that: the Sahara is the largest hot desert, but the largest desert of all is Antarctica. **[pause]**

Even when rain does come, it usually falls in one short, heavy storm, and much of it evaporates, or turns into water vapour, within a few hours. So how does anything survive? The answer is adaptations: special features that help a living thing to survive in its habitat. **[pause]**

Take the cactus. Most plants lose a lot of water through their leaves. A cactus, on the other hand, has sharp spines instead of leaves, and as a result, far less water escapes into the air. Its thick stem stores water like a tank, while its roots spread out widely, just below the surface. **[pause]**

Many desert animals are nocturnal: they shelter from the heat of the day and look for food at night. The fennec fox has enormous ears, which release heat from its body, whereas the Arctic fox has small ears that keep heat in. Many people think a camel's hump is full of water. In fact, it is full of fat, which the camel can turn into energy when food is scarce. **[pause]**

The most remarkable example, though, is a beetle from the Namib Desert, in south-west Africa. On foggy mornings, it climbs to the top of a sand dune and leans forward into the wind. Tiny drops of water from the fog collect on its back and then roll down into its mouth. **[pause]**

So, next time someone tells you that a desert is an empty place, you might ask them how carefully they have looked.

**What the talk contains** (measured from the script above): 364 words in 23 sentences, an average of 16 words per sentence. 23% of its words are not among the 2000 most common English words in the `wordfreq` lists; with the method of `02_Listening_Evidence_Statement` (word endings matched, names of places not counted) the figure is about 19%, against 6 to 15% for the version 1 scripts. Features: a process (how the beetle collects water) and cause and effect (spines, so less water escapes); comparisons (a cactus and most plants; the fennec fox and the Arctic fox; desert and Shanghai rainfall); numbers (250 millimetres, more than a thousand, a third, a few hours); subject words explained in passing (precipitation, evaporates, adaptations, habitat, nocturnal); a self-correction ("Actually, I need to correct that"); a misconception corrected ("In fact"); an opinion that is implied, not stated (the last sentence); discourse markers (however, while, by comparison, on the other hand, as a result, whereas, in fact, though).

**Answers.** One mark each (questions 12 and 13 are one mark per gap). Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Short answers and notes are fine: the writing is not marked here. Answers must be in English. The questions follow the order of the talk; question 16 is about the whole talk.

| Q | Skill | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept, and what it tells you |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Specific detail (a number) | **250** (millimetres) | two hundred and fifty | 1000 or "a thousand" (Shanghai's rainfall): heard the comparison, not the definition. |
| 10 | Specific detail (a name) | **Antarctica** | | The Sahara: missed the self-correction ("Actually, I need to correct that: the Sahara is the largest hot desert"). The Namib: caught a later name only. |

| Q | Skill | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept, and what it tells you |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11 | Inference joining two parts of the talk | Rain does not last long in a desert: it comes in one short storm and much of it evaporates within a few hours, so roots just below the surface can take in the water quickly, before it evaporates. | Any answer that links the roots to the rain disappearing quickly: "to catch the rain fast before it dries up"; "the water evaporates quickly, so the roots must get it quickly"; "the rain only comes for a short time". | "To get water" or "to drink water" with no link to the rain disappearing quickly (a literal answer that does not join the two parts); "to hold the cactus up"; "because it rains a lot". |
| 12 | Note completion | **heat** | body heat; heat from its body; the heat; hot air | "water", "sound"; "cold" (mixed up with the Arctic fox's small ears that keep heat in). |
| 13 | Note completion | **fat** | fats; fat for energy | "water": the belief the teacher corrects ("Many people think a camel's hump is full of water. In fact, it is full of fat"): heard the first sentence, missed "In fact". "Energy" alone: what the fat becomes, not what fills the hump. |
| 14 | Process: a sequence | From the top: **3, 1, 4, 2** (climbs the dune, leans into the wind, drops collect on its back, water rolls into its mouth) | | Any other order: 0. All four must be right for the mark. "Leans" before "climbs" usually means the student caught the words but not the order. |
| 15 | Speaker's attitude (implied) | **They have not looked carefully enough.** | | "They are right": took "an empty place" at face value and missed the meaning of "you might ask them how carefully they have looked". |
| 16 | Main idea | **how plants and animals survive with very little water** | | "why deserts are always hot and sandy" (the talk says the opposite; caught "sand" and "sunshine" from the opening); "camels" (one detail). |

**Band guide v2 (listening, / 16).** Use the part scores, in this order:

| Result | Band |
|---|---|
| Part A 0 to 2 | **A** |
| Part A 3 to 4 | **B** |
| Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2 | **C** |
| Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5 | **D** |
| Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8 | **E** |

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example Part A 6 with Part B 6, which can happen when a student misses one picture item but follows the talk well): look at which items were lost, and check against "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet.

**What to look for**

- In Part A, questions 1 to 4 each have a distractor. A student who chooses the distractor every time is catching single words ("cinema", "ten", "dad") without the sentence around them: typical of band B. Questions 7 and 8 need inference.
- Part A shows secure everyday listening; Part B shows whether the student can follow a lesson at normal speed. A fluent Year 7 listener answers most of Part B quickly, including questions 11 and 15, which depend on joining ideas rather than catching words.

- Questions 10 and 13 have a strong distractor that is said first and then corrected ("Actually", "In fact"). A student who chooses the Sahara or writes "water" is following word by word and missing how the speaker's ideas connect: typical of band C or low D.
- A student who scores 7 or 8 in Part A but 0 to 2 in Part B copes with everyday English but will find lessons in English hard at first: band C, with listening support planned.
- **English barrier or something else?** If a student scores low but follows your spoken instructions easily, check whether the problem was speed (they may do better in conversation) or attention. Note it for the interview on the Reading front sheet.

### 3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Reading pages. Read the texts and answer the questions. There are two parts. Part B is harder than Part A. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Start the timer. Do not read the texts or questions aloud, and do not explain words. You may repeat this instruction. Give a two-minute warning.

**Mark scheme.** Spelling and grammar are not marked in reading answers if the meaning is clear. Answers copied from the text are fine when they answer the question. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

**Part A: After-school clubs** (a notice; very accessible, with pictures)

| Q | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Tuesday | Tue | |
| 2 | Room 14 | 14 | Library |
| 3 | 5:30 pm | 5:30, half past five, 17:30 | 4:15 |
| 4 | Basketball | | |
| 5 | a False · b True · c False | | 1 mark for each correct row (3 marks) |
| 6 | Drama | Drama Club | Art |

**Part B: Mist** (fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 11; this was Part C in version 1, with the same questions and answers, renumbered)

| Q | Skill | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | Retrieval | Next to Tom | By the window; at the empty desk by the window | |
| 8 | Retrieval | A place they loved | A favourite place; a place they like | His grandfather's tea garden (what Chen Yu drew, not what was asked) |
| 9 | Inference | He was alone and did not want people to see it. | He had nobody to talk to; he was shy, nervous or lonely; he did not know anyone; so nobody would notice him | He was hungry; the rice was hot |
| 10 | Vocabulary in context | flow fast, like a river | | |
| 11 | Inference with evidence (2) | **1 mark** for a feeling: nervous, shy, lonely, worried, scared, uncomfortable, sad, alone, not happy. **1 mark** for evidence that fits: he counted the faces; nobody looked up; he kept his eyes on the board; he copied every word; Tom did not say a word; he sat at the end of the table; he ate slowly to look busy. | Evidence in the student's own words | A positive feeling ("happy", "excited") scores 0 for the feeling; the evidence mark can still be given if the evidence is correct. |

| Q | Skill | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12 | Why do you think | To make a joke; to make Chen Yu feel welcome or relaxed. | To show the club is friendly and you do not need to be good at sport; because Tom is bad at football too; to make him laugh | "Because they play football in the club" |
| 13 | Author's purpose | The grey streets show Chen Yu's feelings: he feels happier or more hopeful now, because he has made a friend. | He is not lonely now; his day got better; things seem better because of Tom and the art club | "Because the rain stopped" (not in the text: a literal reading; note it) |

**Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)**

| Result | Band |
|---|---|
| Part A 0 to 3 | **A** |
| Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2 | **B** |
| Part B 3 to 5 | **C** |
| Part B 6 to 8 | **D** or **E** (see below) |

**D or E.** Part B is the age-level text, so 6 or more shows at least a competent reader. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. Version 3.1 has no text above age level, so the reading paper alone cannot confirm band E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

**What to look for**

- Part B (Mist) is the age-level story: a fluent reader of 11 scores 6 or more.
- A student who does Part A well but leaves the end of Part B blank may have run out of time rather than understanding. Note where they stopped at 15 minutes on the Reading front sheet.
- **English barrier or reading difficulty?** Most students in this pack are learning English, so low scores usually reflect vocabulary. If a student reads aloud fluently in the sentence reading screen but scores low here, the gap is vocabulary and comprehension, not decoding. If a student is slow and inaccurate in both, and also reads slowly in Chinese (ask the parents), note a possible reading difficulty on the Reading front sheet.

## 3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task and tick it. Plan in the box first. Then write. Try to write about 20 lines. You have 10 minutes." You may repeat the instruction. Do not explain the prompts.

**The tasks**

- **Task 1 (narrative):** a story that begins "When Mei opened the box, she could not believe her eyes."
- **Task 2 (opinion):** "The school summer holiday should be shorter." Do you agree?

**Marking.** Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 are between the descriptions). Total / 16. Then give the band by **best fit** with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, using the total only as a check.

| Criterion | 0 | 2 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Content and organisation** | Nothing in English, or isolated words; no link to the task. | A short response that follows the task; ideas listed with simple links ("and", "then"); a beginning but a weak or missing ending; little paragraphing. | A complete, well-shaped story or argument for the age: an opening that sets the scene or position, ideas developed with detail or reasons and examples, a clear ending; paragraphs; the reader is kept in mind. |

| Criterion | 0 | 2 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Vocabulary** | Single memorised words or copied words. | Everyday words used correctly; some repetition; gaps filled with simple words or Chinese. | A wide range for the age, chosen for effect (precise verbs and adjectives, some less common words); words for linking ideas ("however", "although", "for example"). |
| **Grammar and sentences** | No sentences. | Simple sentences, some joined with "and", "but", "because"; frequent errors (verb tenses, plurals, articles, word order) but meaning is mostly clear. | Varied sentences, including complex ones ("When ...", "which ...", "if ..."); tenses controlled (past for the story, present for the opinion); errors are rare and do not affect meaning. |
| **Spelling and punctuation** | Spelling makes most words hard to read; no punctuation. | Common words spelt correctly; longer words phonetically plausible; full stops and capital letters used, not always correctly. | Accurate spelling, including most longer words; sentence punctuation secure; commas, question marks, apostrophes and speech marks mostly correct. |

**Rough guide to the total** (best fit decides): 0 to 3 **A** · 4 to 7 **B** · 8 to 10 **C** · 11 to 13 **D** · 14 to 16 **E**.

**Band E writing at Year 7.** Comparable to a fluent writer of 11 or 12. In 10 minutes, usually 150 to 250 words in clear paragraphs. The story has a real event and an ending, with some dialogue or description; the opinion gives a clear view, two or three reasons with examples, and often mentions the other side. Sentences are varied and controlled, vocabulary is chosen with care, and errors are few and minor. Some fluent writers write less in 10 minutes but very well: judge quality, not just length.

**What to look for**

- Typical features of Chinese-speaking learners (missing past tense -ed or plural -s, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed) are normal stages of learning English. Score them under grammar, but read past them to judge content.
- A student who writes a strong plan but few lines may think well but write slowly in English: note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- Writing much weaker than speaking is common in students from oral-heavy English courses. Writing much stronger than speaking is common in students taught through grammar and textbook dialogues.

### 3.4 Speaking and sentence reading (the interview, 15 minutes)

The interview is 1:1. The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`). It opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen**: the rules, your copy of the sentences and the meaning questions, and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. For Year 7, **start at Level 6 (sentence 16)**, and follow the rules in the guide for going back, stopping, the meaning checks and fluency. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Then use the interview questions (school and learning, interests, friends and wellbeing, future plans and aspirations, values, an opinion question) and give the **speaking band** with the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, recording it on the Interview sheet.

**Pace.** Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2 (about 160 words a minute), the same for every candidate.

The Interviewer guide's opinion questions include homework and phones. These do not overlap with the writing tasks above.

## 4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Maths pages. There are three sections. Section A is calculation and algebra. Section B is word questions: read the question, write an equation and solve it. Section C is problems with pictures, tables and charts. You cannot use a calculator. Show your working in the boxes: you can get marks for your working. I can read any question to you. Just ask. You have 25 minutes."

Read any question aloud on request, as often as asked, and point to the picture. Follow the access rules (Section 2): mark **L** if a Chinese-speaking colleague gave a question once in Chinese, and **NT** if the student says they have not

learnt the topic. Answers, reasons and explanations must be in English (numbers and working count).

**What the paper is for.** Version 2 is aimed at the higher end. It starts at the level expected for entry to Year 7 (the end of UK Year 6) and goes well beyond it, into Year 7 and early Year 8 content; there are no easy "floor" questions. It measures three things separately, because students from Chinese schools are usually strong in the first and less practised in the other two: **fluency** (Section A: calculation and algebra with no context), **word questions** (Section B: problems given only in sentences, which the student must read and set up) and **applied problems** (Section C: multi-step problems in real or unfamiliar contexts, with diagrams, charts and "Show" or "Explain").

**Marking.** Accept any clear, correct method. A correct answer scores full marks, with or without working, except where the question says **Show** or **Explain** (questions 14 and 18c) or asks for reasons (16): there the working or reason is part of the answer. In Section B, a correct answer scores 2 however it was found (an equation, a bar model, or trial and improvement with a check). Accept equivalent answers (for example 6/10 for 3/5) unless the question says otherwise. Units are printed on the paper, so a missing unit does not lose a mark. **M1** is a method mark: give it for a correct method with one arithmetic slip, or for the step named, when the final answer is wrong.

**Section A: Fluency (10 marks)**

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | a 4 7/12 · b 3/5 | 1 + 1 | a: 55/12, 3 19/12. 3 8/10 means the student added the numerators and the denominators. b: 0.6, 24/40, 6/10. 64/15 or 4 4/15 means the student multiplied instead of dividing. | Adding mixed numbers with different denominators (the expected level for entry); dividing mixed numbers |
| 2 | 80 | 1 | 8 or 800: a place value slip. | Dividing by a decimal |
| 3 | 100 | 1 | 316 means $(3 \times 6)^2$; 5.5 means the student worked from left to right ((108 – 64) ÷ 8). | Order of operations with powers and brackets |
| 4 | 19 | 1 | –1 means 5 × (–2) was taken as +10; 1 means $(-3)^2$ was taken as –9. | Negative numbers and powers |
| 5 | 42 | 1 | Usually 10% + 5% + 2.5% = 24 + 12 + 6. | Percentages of amounts |
| 6 | $2x - 15$ | 1 | $-15 + 2x$. $2x - 5$ means only the first term was multiplied; $10x - 15$ means $4x$ was added. | Expanding a bracket and collecting like terms |
| 7 | 33 | 1 | –15 (9 – 24, a sign error in $-2ab$); 15 ($(-3)^2$ taken as –9). | Substitution with negative numbers |
| 8 | –3.5 | 1 | –7/2, –3½, –14/4. 3.5 is a sign error; 6.5 or –6.5 means 6 was added to 20. | Solving a two-step equation with a negative answer |
| 9 | $26 - 3n$ | 1 | $-3n + 26$. "Subtract 3" (the term-to-term rule) scores 0 but shows partial understanding: note it. $23 - 3n$ or $3n + 20$ score 0. | The $n$th term of a decreasing sequence |

**Section B: Word questions (8 marks)**

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | 11 | 2 | **M1** for $3(n + 6) = 51$, $(n + 6) \times 3 = 51$, or $51 \div 3 = 17$ seen. 33 (from $n + 6 \times 3 = 51$) means the order in the sentences was not followed; 15 (from $3n + 6 = 51$) the same. | "I think of a number": brackets from words |
| 11 | ¥2 (2.00) | 2 | **M1** for $3(p + 2.50) + 2p = 17.50$, or $5p + 7.50 = 17.50$, or a trial checked correctly. 4.50 (the pen, not the pencil) scores 1. 3 (from $3p + 2.50 + 2p = 17.50$, with the 2.50 counted once) and 3.50 (17.50 ÷ 5) score 0. | Costs: forming and solving an equation with decimals |
| 12 | 126 ($cm^2$) | 2 | **M1** for width 9 or length 14 (from $4w + 10 = 46$ or $2(w + w + 5) = 46$). 9 or 14 as the final answer scores 1. 132.25 (treated as a square, 11.5 × 11.5) scores 0. | Perimeter with algebraic sides, then area |
| 13 | 15 | 2 | **M1** for $3a + 5 = 2(a + 5)$, or Aisha's age 5 seen. 5 as the final answer (Aisha's age) scores 1. 30 (from $3a = 2(a + 5)$, forgetting that Amir also gets 5 years older) scores 0. | Ages: an equation with the unknown on both sides |

**Section C: Applied problems (12 marks)**

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | Carton **B** (1.2 litres) | 2 | **M1** for values that compare the two cartons by a correct method, for example ¥16.80 and ¥16.00 a litre; ¥1.68 and ¥1.60 for 100 ml; ¥2.52 and ¥2.40 for 150 ml; ¥50.40 and ¥48.00 for 3 litres; or ¥20.16 for 1.2 litres at Carton A's price. **A1** for correct values and B. "B" with no working, or "B because it is bigger", scores 0 (the question says Show). | Best buy: proportional reasoning with decimals and mixed units (ml and litres) |
| 15 | 21 (points) | 2 | **M1** for 44 and 11 (the total and mean of games 1 to 4) with 13 seen, or 65 (5 × 13). 16 (60 – 44, using a mean of 12) and 13 (the new mean given as the score) score 0. | The mean with a missing value; reading a bar chart |
| 16 | $x$ = 65, $y$ = 115 (degrees) | 3 | **1** for $x$ = 65. **1** for $y$ = 115 (follow through: 180 – their $x$). **1** for a correct reason for $x$ **and** a correct reason for $y$ (both are needed for this mark): for $x$, vertically opposite angles are equal (angle AXB = 50°) or the base angles of an isosceles triangle are equal, or angles in a triangle add up to 180°; for $y$, angles on a straight line add up to 180°, or the exterior angle of a triangle equals the sum of the two opposite interior angles (50 + 65). Simple words are fine ("opposite angles are the same", "two equal sides so two equal angles", "a straight line is 180"). $x$ = 50 (the given angle copied) scores 0. | Angle reasoning with reasons: vertically opposite angles, isosceles triangles, angles on a straight line |
| 17 | 12:15 | 2 | 12:15 pm, 12.15, quarter past twelve. **M1** for 300 layers (60 ÷ 0.2), 9000 seconds, 150 minutes or 2 hours 30 minutes. 2 hours 30 minutes as the final answer scores 1. 10:00 (from 30 layers: 6 ÷ 0.2, with centimetres not changed to millimetres) scores 0. | Rates in an unfamiliar context; changing units (cm and mm, seconds, minutes and hours); time |
| 18 | a 26 · b 22 · c see the next column | 1 + 1 + 1 | a: 2 × 10 + 6, or counting on in twos from 8. b: 22 (22 grey tiles use 2 × 22 + 6 = 50 white tiles; 23 would need 52). 22.5 or 23 scores 0. c: any correct general reason: the number of white tiles is $2n + 6 = 2(n + 3)$, which is a multiple of 2; the white tiles are two equal rows (above and below) plus 2 at the ends; each new grey tile adds 2 white tiles, starting from 8. "8, 10 and 12 are even" (examples only) scores 0, because it does not explain why every pattern is even. | A linear pattern in context; the largest whole number that fits; explaining a general rule |

**Totals:** Fluency (Section A) / 10 · Word questions (Section B) / 8 · Applied (Section C) / 12 · **Total / 30**.

**Band guide v2 (maths, / 30; provisional, for a harder paper):** 0 to 10 **1** Below expected (under 35%) · 11 to 16 **2** Working towards (35 to 54%) · 17 to 22 **3** Expected (55 to 74%) · 23 to 30 **4** Greater depth, likely top set (75% or more). List NT questions, and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught. These cut-offs are lower than in version 1 because the paper is harder; review them after the first 20 to 30 candidates.

**Reading the three sub-scores**

| Profile | What it usually means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| Fluency high (8 to 10), word questions low (0 to 4) | The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier. | Read the word questions aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the student then solves them, record on the grading sheet that the barrier is English. |
| Fluency and word questions high, applied low (under 6) | Strong calculation and setting up, less practice in multi-step problems, choosing a method and explaining. | The student needs teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet, for the maths teacher. |
| All three high (23 or more in total) | Greater depth. | Likely top set. |
| Fluency low, mostly on NT topics (1b, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9) | Gaps from the different order of topics in Chinese schools. | List the NT topics and judge whether the student will reach band 3 once taught. |

| Profile | What it usually means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| Fluency low on familiar topics (1a, 2) | A real gap in calculation. | Note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet, with the word question and applied scores, for the maths teacher. |

**May not have been taught.** A Year 7 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed Grade 5 (PEP sequence; other textbooks differ a little, so ask the student). These topics are usually taught in Grade 6 or later, so the student **may not have been taught** them:

| Questions | Topic | Usually taught in China |
|---|---|---|
| 1b | Dividing fractions (adding fractions with different denominators and mixed numbers is Grade 5) | Grade 6 |
| 3 | Powers such as $4^3$ (squares may be familiar from area) | Grade 7 |
| 4, 7 | Calculating with negative numbers | Grade 6 (meaning), Grade 7 (operations) |
| 5 | Percentages | Grade 6 |
| 6 | Expanding brackets and collecting like terms | Grade 7 |
| 8 | An equation with a negative answer (simple equations are Grade 5) | Grade 7 |
| 9, 18 | A rule for the *n*th term (spotting patterns is common; letters for numbers is Grade 5) | Not taught formally |
| 13 | An equation with the unknown on both sides, such as $3a + 5 = 2(a + 5)$ (age problems are often solved without algebra in Chinese primary schools, and any correct method scores) | Grade 7 |
| 16 | Vertically opposite angles (isosceles triangles, the angle sum of a triangle and angles on a straight line are Grade 4) | Grade 7 |

Usually **familiar**: decimals, including dividing by a decimal (Grade 5); adding and subtracting fractions (Grade 5); solving word problems with an equation (Grade 5, and often practised a lot in Chinese, so Section B mainly tests whether the student can read the problem in English); unit prices; the mean (Grade 4); perimeter and area (Grade 3); 24-hour time (Grade 3).

**What to look for**

- **Compare the three sub-scores** (table above) before deciding that a student is weak at maths.
- In Section B, a student who writes a correct equation but makes a slip has understood the English. A student who leaves the section blank, or combines the numbers in the order they appear (for example 6 × 3 + 51), has probably been stopped by the English: read the question aloud and see.
- Questions 14, 16 and 18c ask the student to show, give reasons or explain. Many students from Chinese schools give correct answers without reasons. A correct number with no reason gets the answer marks only. That is useful information for teachers, not a sign of weak maths.
- Strong students get 3, 8, 9, 13, 15, 17 and 18b, and give general reasons in 18c. Question 17 is an unfamiliar context: a student who changes 6 cm to 60 mm without being told is reading the problem carefully.

## 5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Science pages. There are 6 questions. I can read any question to you. You have 8 minutes." The same access rules as maths apply (L and NT). Spelling does not matter in science answers if the word is recognisable (for example "ginko", "oxigen").

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | A ginkgo · B maple · C lotus | 2 | **2** for all three; **1** for two. Uses a key (working scientifically). | Classification keys |
| 2 | oxygen | 1 | Carbon dioxide is a common confusion (it is given out in the lungs). | The heart and blood |

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | a 130 · b His muscles need more oxygen (or energy), so the heart pumps blood faster to carry it to them. | 1 + 1 | a: reading a graph between labelled gridlines. b: accept "his body needs more oxygen", "to get more energy to the muscles", "more blood goes to the muscles". Not: "because he is tired", "because running is hard". | Exercise and health; reading a graph |
| 4 | a bulb, switch, cell (left to right) · b **B** | 1 + 1 | a: all three for the mark. b: C (two bulbs) means the student thinks more bulbs give more light. | Circuit symbols; more cells and brighter bulbs |
| 5 | a the puppet she uses · b smaller | 1 + 1 | b: shorter, small, lower, less tall. "Bigger" means the table was read the wrong way. | Light and shadows; fair tests and variables; reading a table |
| 6 | The rocks were once under the sea. | 1 | The land or mountain was once the sea bed; the sea was there long ago; the rocks moved up from the sea. Not: "the animals climbed up", "a bird carried them". | Fossils and evolution |

**Band guide (science, / 10; provisional):** 0 to 3 **1** · 4 to 5 **2** · 6 to 8 **3** · 9 to 10 **4**.

**May not have been taught.** Primary science (科学) in China covers these areas but the textbooks differ, so a Year 7 entrant **may not have been taught**: dichotomous keys (Q1; sorting living things is usually familiar), the heart and circulation in detail (Q2, Q3b; this comes fully in Grade 7 biology), circuit symbols (Q4a; circuits are Grade 4, often with drawings rather than symbols), and fossils and evolution (Q6). Light and shadows (Q5) are usually taught in Grade 5.

**What to look for**

- Questions 1, 3 and 5 test working scientifically (using a key, reading a graph and a table, fair tests). A student who does these well thinks scientifically even if the topic knowledge is NT.
- Short or one-word answers are fine. Answers must be in English; an explanation in Chinese scores 0.

## 6. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y07_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen, any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
4. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
5. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days. The overall English band is the band most of the four skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands below the others.
6. **File the marked student paper with them** (or shred it under the school's policy).